

Belle Belle

Nokia is rolling out Symbian Belle update earlier than expected

Windows 8 tablet requirements

Microsoft documentation has revealed the hardware certification requirements of Windows 8 tablets

Nokia Lumia 710

Premium sub-20k smartphone running on WP 7.5



Specifications

Platform: Windows Phone 7.5 (Mango); **Processor:** Qualcomm MSM8255 Snapdragon 1.4GHz; **RAM:** 512MB; **Display:** 3.7-inch (480 x 800 pixel); **Storage:** 8GB internal; **Camera:** 5MP, 720p videos; **Battery:** 1300 mAh

Contact

Nokia India

Phone: +91 22 3030 3838

Email: www.nokia.co.in

Price: ₹18,999

7.5
10

Features 7.0
Performance 7.5
Build Quality 7.5
Value for Money 8.0

If the Nokia Lumia 800 was an indicator of what Nokia plans to do with its Windows Phone Mango devices, then the future certainly looks bright. The Nokia Lumia 710 is targeted at a consumer, who doesn't wish to spend more than ₹20,000 on a phone, but would love to have a device that feels premium.

Look & Feel

Straightaway, you know that the Nokia Lumia 710 is thicker and heavier than the Samsung Omnia W. But that doesn't take away the fact that the build quality has a premium feel to it. It doesn't have the unibody design of the Nokia Lumia 800, but the more conventional one - remove back panel to access battery. Three hardware keys - Return, Windows and Search, accompany the 3.7-inch display. There is a choice of two colours - black and white, but you can get a lot of colours for the battery cover.

Flip the phone over and there is the 5MP camera with flash towards the top, and the hands-free speaker towards the bottom. The volume rocker and the camera key are on the right side panel, while the 3.5mm headphone jack is on the top along with the power key and the micro USB slot.

The plastic used is high quality, and we didn't feel any extra depression or rough edges at all.

Features & Performance

The Nokia Lumia 710 has the same hardware specs as the Samsung Omnia W. The Qualcomm Snapdragon MSM8255 Snapdragon processor clocking

at 1.4GHz powers it, and is paired with 512MB RAM. The performance of Windows Phone 7.5 (Mango) on this hardware was excellent when we reviewed the Omnia W and likewise for the Lumia 710. Probably one of the benefits of not allowing the manufacturer to add extra customization on the phones, which has been Android's Achilles heel.

The display on the Nokia Lumia 710 is a simple LCD, while the Omnia W comes with Super AMOLED display. Both the phones have the Gorilla Glass feature. While the Omnia W takes the lead in terms of brightness and contrast, the Nokia Lumia 710 surprisingly has deeper blacks and the text feels a lot crisper, helping mostly with reading web pages and emails. While we expected the Super AMOLED on the Omnia W to be miles ahead in terms of the overall package, the Nokia Lumia 710's display does have quite a few things going for it.

Windows Phone OS's Metro UI is possibly the most interesting. To see all apps, just flick open the screen on the right. Now you can vertically scroll through all the apps that are installed on the phone. The UI offers very limited options in terms of personalization. The changes you can make are limited to re-arranging tiles, changing accent colour and the colour of the background and changing the lock-screen image.

The 5MP camera is nothing to be very proud about. It takes decent images in bright light, but noisy images when it becomes slightly darker. Even on a sunny day, pictures lack sharpness. The ability to take 720p HD videos seems more like something

designed for the spec sheets, than for actual performance!

If the iOS has Apple's iPod feature built-in, this one has Microsoft's Zune. We still haven't seen a more beautiful presentation of the music collection on any portable device till now!

Surprisingly, the Nokia Lumia 710 has a smaller battery than the Omnia W. And it shows - this one will completely discharge in just over a day, under medium-heavy use.

The Lumia 710, more so when considering the price, should be on your shortlist if you are considering a Windows Phone 7 handset. Its neck to neck with the Samsung Omnia W in terms of overall performance. The Omnia W is lighter and slimmer than the 710. But the 710 has much better display than the Omnia. Its a tough choice, but in the end it ultimately boils down to your preference of the design, brand, colour etc. Read more online: <http://bit.ly/yb06bw>

Visbal Mathur

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